a student. Since Mhow was a peace station, I would have to vacate the SF in Delhi and accordingly, I applied for a house at Mhow. Here too, there was a waiting list and I would get a house only by June that year, into which I shifted during the break between the two courses, HC 41 beginning only in July 2012. During the break, we also went to Singapore for Amala's graduation. The event, held at the SMU, was called the 'Commencement Ceremony', as graduation was not the end, but only the beginning of a long journey. On reflection, this was true even for us, where the passing-out parade and going over the 'Antim Pag' were just the beginning of our careers.

At the HC Wing, the first task at hand was to correct all the dissertations that the student officers had submitted. There were close to a hundred students, so each DS got about twenty dissertations each. These had to be assessed in a timebound manner not only since the course terminated in March, but since this was also a mandatory requirement for the grant of an MPhil degree by the Devi Ahilyabai Vishwa Vidyalaya, Indore, to which the AWC was affiliated. There were also awards for the three best dissertations, so we had to do justice to the assessments. My own thesis as a student officer on 'The Psychology of Terrorism', had been long-listed and then short-listed for these awards, so I knew its worth. The next was the conduct of the JOCAP, the Joint Capsule, wherein the students of the Navy and Air War Colleges also come to Mhow for a series of tri-service events, including talks by all the Service Chiefs, culminating in a tri-service war game, the grand finale. The course ends shortly thereafter in April. The months of May and June are spent on various administrative activities, as well as honing the training programme for the next course, including identifying the possible guest speakers who could address the next course. It is quite a well-oiled system.

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